

HTTP Fundamentals

Backend development study note for document retrieval and grounded question-answering practice.

What is HTTP?

HTTP (Hypertext Transfer Protocol) is an application-layer protocol used for communication between clients and servers. A client sends a request and a server returns a response. Browsers, mobile applications, and backend services can act as HTTP clients.

Statelessness

HTTP is stateless at the protocol level: each request is interpreted independently. Applications can associate requests with a user or session using mechanisms such as cookies, session identifiers, or tokens.

Request and response

An HTTP request commonly contains a method, path, headers, and optionally a body. A response contains a status code, headers, and optionally a body.